Podium Browser for Rhino

Installation and User Guide - version 1.0.1 - Cadalog Inc.

Podium Browser for Rhino puts the Podium Browser content library inside Rhino as a dockable panel. Browse or search the library, switch between the Rhino (.3dm) and SketchUp (.skp) catalogs, and click a model to download it and place it in your open Rhino document - no manual downloading, unzipping or importing.

1. Before you install

Requirement	Details
Operating system	Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit). This release is Windows-only.
Rhino	Rhino 8 (any recent service release).
Microsoft Edge WebView2	Already present on Windows 11 and installed with Rhino 8. If the panel opens blank, install the free "Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime" from Microsoft.
Internet connection	Required - the library and the models are downloaded on demand.
Podium Browser license	Free items work without a license. Paid items require your Podium Browser license key, entered in the panel exactly as you would on the website.

Close Rhino before installing. Rhino locks the plug-in file while it is running.

2. Choose an installation method

This package contains two folders - two ways to install the same plug-in. Pick *one*.

Folder	Best for	Effort
1 - Package Manager (recommended)	Normal use. Rhino tracks the version and can update or remove it cleanly.	One click inside Rhino.
2 - Manual (rhp)	Testing, or if the Package Manager is blocked by IT policy.	Drag one file onto Rhino.

Option 1 - Package Manager (recommended)

If the package has been published to the Rhino package server:

1. Start Rhino and run the `PackageManager` command (also on the Tools menu).
2. Search for **Podium Browser**.
3. Click **Install**, then restart Rhino.

To install the file supplied in folder 1 instead:

1. Close Rhino.
2. Open a Command Prompt (press the Windows key, type `cmd`, press Enter).
3. Run the command below, replacing the folder path with the location of folder "1 - Package Manager (recommended)" on your computer:

```
"C:\Program Files\Rhino 8\System\Yak.exe" install --source "D:\Podium
Browser for Rhino\1 - Package Manager (recommended)" podium-browser
```

4. Start Rhino. The plug-in loads automatically.

> To update later, run the same command again with the newer package; to remove it, run `"C:\Program Files\Rhino 8\System\Yak.exe" uninstall podium-browser`.

Option 2 - Manual (.rhp)

1. Copy the whole "2 - Manual (rhp)" folder somewhere permanent, for example `C:\Program Files\Cadalog\Podium Browser for Rhino`. Keep the `runtimes` sub-folder next to the plug-in file.
2. Start Rhino.
3. Drag `CadalogWebPlugin.rhp` from that folder onto an open Rhino viewport.
4. Confirm the security prompt asking whether to load the plug-in.

Rhino remembers the location, so the plug-in loads by itself from then on. If you move or delete the folder, Rhino will report the plug-in as missing.

3. Using the plug-in

Opening the panel

1. Type `PodiumBrowser` on the Rhino command line and press Enter. (Running it again closes the panel.)
2. Drag the panel by its title to dock it - the right-hand side works well - and drag its inner edge to widen it.

Choosing a catalog

The **Catalog** dropdown at the top of the panel switches the library:

- **Rhino catalog (.3dm)** - native Rhino models. Recommended.

- **SketchUp catalog (.skp)** - the original SketchUp library. Rhino 8 imports these natively as well.

Your choice is remembered the next time you start Rhino.

Finding and placing a model

1. Browse the categories on the left, or use the search box at the top of the page.
2. Tick **Show Only Free Files** if you do not have a license key yet.
3. Click the download icon on a model.
4. The plug-in downloads the file and imports it. Progress is reported on the Rhino command line, prefixed with `[Cadalog]`.
5. The model arrives attached to your cursor: **click once in a viewport to drop it** where you want it.

The placed geometry is ordinary Rhino geometry - move, scale, rotate or explode it as usual. `Undo` removes it if you change your mind.

License key

Free items need no key. To unlock the paid library, enter your Podium Browser license key using the account button in the panel, exactly as you would on the Podium Browser website.

4. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
"Unknown command: PodiumBrowser"	The plug-in is not loaded. Open Tools > Options > Plug-ins, search for "Podium Browser" and tick it, then restart Rhino.
The panel is blank or white	The Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime is missing. Install it from Microsoft (search for "WebView2 Runtime"), then restart Rhino.
Nothing happens after clicking download	Check the Rhino command line for lines beginning with `[Cadalog]`. No lines at all usually means the item is a paid item and no valid license key is entered.
The model arrives far too large or too small	The model file and your document use different units. Set your document units (`Units` command) before inserting, or scale the object afterwards.
The model is placed but not attached to the cursor	Rhino's importer did not leave it selected. Select the new objects and use `Move` to position them.
Installation fails saying a file is in use	Rhino is still running. Close every Rhino window and try again.

Downloaded files are staged in `%TEMP%\Cadalog\downloads`. They can be deleted at any time; they are only a working copy - the geometry lives in your Rhino document.

5. Uninstalling

- **Package Manager:** run `PackageManager` in Rhino, select Podium Browser and click Uninstall. Or, with Rhino closed, run `"C:\Program Files\Rhino 8\System\Yak.exe" uninstall podium-browser`. If anything is left behind, the files live in `%AppData%\McNeel\Rhinoceros\packages\8.0` - close Rhino and delete the "podium-browser" folder there.
- **Manual (.rhp):** open Tools > Options > Plug-ins, untick the plug-in, restart Rhino, then delete the folder you copied.

6. Support

Please include your Rhino version (Help > About), your Windows version, and any `[Cadalog]` lines from the Rhino command line when reporting a problem - they usually identify the cause immediately.